DAVAO RESEARCH JOURNAL
DAVAO ORIENTAL STATE UNIVERSITY • PUBLICATION OFFICE
ISSN: 2094-814X (Print)
ISSN: 2984-7540 (Online)
Official Institutional Document

TERMS OF REFERENCE (TOR) & FINAL ACCEPTANCE REPORT

Project Title: Technical Consultancy and Systems Development Services for the Davao Research Journal (DRJ) Modern Editorial Manager® Ecosystem
Procuring Entity / Client: Davao Oriental State University (DORSU) — Publication and Research Office
Beneficiary Publication: Davao Research Journal (DRJ) • ISSN: 2094-814X (Print), 2984-7540 (Online)
Contract Type: Technical Consultancy & Custom Software Engineering
Project Status: 100% Completed, Verified, and Deployed
Applicable Standard: Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Journal Accreditations / Scopus / Web of Science Indexing Readiness Guidelines

1. Project Background and Rationale

The Davao Oriental State University (DORSU), through the Davao Research Journal (DRJ), publishes high-impact multidisciplinary scientific papers. To meet international journal indexing benchmarks (Scopus, Web of Science, ASEAN Citation Index) and satisfy CHED research dissemination criteria, academic publishing systems must provide: * High-speed, transparent peer review cycles. * Uncompromised manuscript confidentiality and blind review integrity. * Frictionless experience for international reviewers, authors, and editors.

This project has successfully delivered a **complete 3-Module Editorial Suite** integrating with DORSU's live OJS 3.4 installation, replacing cumbersome traditional reviewer forms with a high-end **Aries Editorial Manager®** experience.

2. Scope of Work & Completed Deliverables

All three (3) essential publishing modules have been verified and operationalized:

Module 1: Author Submission & Tracking Module *(Completed)*

- **Live System URL:** `https://davaoresearchjournal.ph/index.php/drj/submission/wizard`
- **Features Delivered:**
- Multi-step guided author submission wizard.
- Automated file uploads (.docx, .pdf, supplementary data) with author checklist verification.

- Real-time submission milestone tracking.

Module 2: Editorial Management & Decision Hub *(Completed)*

- **Live System URL:** `https://davaoresearchjournal.ph/index.php/drj/workflow/index`
- **Features Delivered:**
- Editorial triage and section editor assignment cockpit.
- 1-click reviewer search, assignment, and tracking.
- Outbound email invitation delivery via **Resend SMTP Relay (Port 465 SSL)** bypassing VPS firewall blocks.
- Multi-reviewer recommendation collation and decision dispatch (Accept, Minor, Major, Reject).

Module 3: Aries Editorial Manager® Reviewer Workspace *(Completed)*

- **Live System URL:** `https://review.davaoresearchjournal.ph`
- **Features Delivered:**
- **Split-Screen Workspace:** Drag-resizable dual split-pane interface synchronizing manuscript document reading and evaluation rubric scoring.
- **Scientific Rubric & Compliance Questionnaire:** 5-point Likert evaluation matrix across five scientific standards; compliance radios for statistical integrity, writing clarity, and conflicts of interest.
- **Dual-Tier Feedback Isolation:** Database-level isolation between Blinded Author Feedback and Confidential Editor Comments.
- **Triple Zero-Trust Security Gates:**
  - *Device Gate:* Automatic detection and blocking of smartphone viewports (< 1024px) with clipboard link copy functionality.
  - *Direct Access Gate:* Frame-0 solid `#00172B` backdrop blocking unauthenticated domain snooping.
  - *Email Verification Gate:* Cryptographic HMAC-SHA256 signature binding with mandatory email identity verification.
- **Reviewer File Attachments:** Reviewers can upload marked-up manuscripts (.docx, .pdf) with track-changes.
- **Printable Official Certificate of Reviewing:** Automated generation of formal **Certificate of Peer Review Recognition** bearing institutional publication credentials and DRJ seal.
- **OJS 3.4 Generic Plugin:** Deployed in OJS at `plugins/generic/editorialManagerReview` registering `index.php/drj/reviewer-portal`.

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3. Technical Deliverables and Acceptance Verification

Deliverable	Detailed Requirements	Verification & Acceptance Standard	Status
D1: Author Module (Module 1)	Guided submission wizard, metadata capture, file upload, status tracker.	Operational in OJS 3.4 core at `davaoresearchjournal.ph`.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D2: Editorial Hub (Module 2)	Desk triage, reviewer assignment, decision dispatcher.	Operational in OJS 3.4 core at `davaoresearchjournal.ph`.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D3: Reviewer Portal (Module 3)	DRJ Adaptive Reactive Workstation Client deployed at `review.davaoresearchjournal.ph`.	Verified live on production server with zero build warnings; all 3 security gates active.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D4: REST API & Security Bridge	PHP 8.2 API (`api.php`) with PDO connection to OJS database (`drj2024_35beta`).	Cryptographic HMAC-SHA256 validation confirmed; unauthorized access rejected.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D5: Outbound SMTP Integration	Resend SMTP Relay integrated over Port 465 SSL in `config.inc.php`.	Invitation emails delivered directly to external Gmail/academic inboxes without spam flagging.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D6: OJS 3.4 Generic Plugin	`editorialManagerReview` generic plugin installed in OJS.	Registered in OJS Plugin Gallery; hooks into `LoadHandler` for URL routing.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**
D7: Technical Documentation & Code	Full TDD, architectural diagrams, Proposal, and GitHub repository.	Clean commit history and comprehensive documentation on GitHub.	**VERIFIED & ACCEPTED**

4. Intellectual Property & Code Ownership

1. **Institutional Ownership:** All custom code, plugins, templates, and configurations developed under this contract are the property of **Davao Oriental State University (DORSU)** and the **Davao Research Journal (DRJ)**.
2. **Open-Source Compliance:** In accordance with OJS licensing, the custom software is governed by the **GNU General Public License v3.0 (GPLv3)**, granting DORSU perpetual, royalty-free rights to modify, deploy, and maintain the software indefinitely.

5. Summary of Commercial Value

Milestone / Deliverable	Scope	Status	Contract Amount
Module 1: Author Submission Module	Multi-step submission wizard, file upload, live status tracking	**Complete**	**₱140,000**
Module 2: Editorial Management Hub	Desk triage, reviewer assignment, Resend SMTP relay, decisions	**Complete**	**₱180,000**
Module 3: Peer Review Workstation	DRJ Reactive Workstation Core, Dual Split Panes, Triple Security Gates, Certificate	**Complete**	**₱160,000**
Integration & Verification	End-to-end integration, database consistency, Resend SMTP tuning	**Complete**	**₱60,000**
TOTAL CONTRACT VALUE:	**Complete 3-Module Modernization Suite**	**100% Complete**	**₱540,000 PHP** (~$9,300 USD)

6. Warranty, Support & Service Level Agreement (SLA)

- **Warranty Period:** Six (6) months of warranty support commencing from the date of final system acceptance.
- **Scope of Warranty:** Rapid resolution of any software defects, bugs, regression issues resulting from OJS minor updates, or email deliverability adjustments.
- **Response Times:**
- *Critical (System Outage / Review Blocked):* Response within 4 hours; resolution within 24 hours.
- *Standard (Minor UI / Enhancement Requests):* Response within 24 hours; resolution within 72 hours.

7. Conforme & Signatures

CONSULTANT / SOFTWARE ARCHITECT:

DARRYL M. NUYDA
Lead Software Architect & Solutions Engineer
Date: October 25, 2026

FOR THE PROCURING ENTITY (DORSU / DRJ):

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF
Davao Research Journal (DRJ)
Date: _____

VICE PRESIDENT FOR RESEARCH, EXTENSION & INNOVATION
Davao Oriental State University (DORSU)
Date: _____

UNIVERSITY PRESIDENT
Davao Oriental State University (DORSU)
Date: _____